

School Committee of the Whole - Roundtable #3 Notes -
Wednesday, June 10, 2020 - via Zoom

Dr. Cushing - Computer crash issue - fixing that now. Thank you for your patience

Mayor - Welcome - Calls subcommittee meeting to order - 4:04 PM - Mr Teixeira

Mt. Teixeira - Hi - May Abuhasan - are you on for Arabic? We can't really hear you. Can you log out and log back in?

Mayor - Roll Call to open meeting

Roll Call Vote - 7-0

Salute the Flag

Mr. Teixeira - Ghislane Pinto for portuguese, are you on? Yes

Mr. Teixeira - Jessie Reinold for spanish, are you on? Yes

Mayor - May?

Member McLaughlin - teachers have the wrong link to Zoom?

Ms. Douglas - I re sent the updated zoom information

Mayor - Dr. Cushing is getting everyone into rooms, we will start in about a minute

Dr. Cushing - I'm going to automatically assign to rooms and then move people as soon as I can so we can get this meeting going

BREAKOUT ROOM SESSIONS

Member McLaughlin - Kudos to Dr. Cushing for re-aligning all of us!!

Mayor - thank you everyone!

Group 1 - Mayor - SOA monies - Lexia is a good use of the money, chromebooks, PD - harder for our younger children to learn online - vocational school and science labs are tougher on line - we know the survey is going out about what the fall will look like and which students aren't able to come back to school - a student suggested automatic sinks so no touching -

Group 2 - Member McLaughlin - a lot of good feedback - SOA - saving 2 teacher's jobs if there will cuts - anti racism curriculum - anonymous student reporting system, as a check in tool - What can't be learned or is difficult to learn or service to provide: SEL, one to one learning for special needs - online shop in vocational - labs are more difficult as well - students who can't access online learning - big picture suggestions - overall uniformity and consistency across the district, I've heard this in every breakout session - orientation with online learning for families and students - standardizing schedules so tech can be used appropriately at home - use a buddy system to have a big brother /sister student to rely on for example for check in

Group 3 - Member Kretz - SOA - can we use it to pay for the internet for all families? Only 50% of families at high school are engaged - PD for teachers - pay for hot spots - online subscriptions for IEP and Core 5 - Online learning issues? If we can't get everyone online connections and devices - has to be equitable - making sure we have correct contact info in school brains - we really need to use some of the \$5M for additional purchase of chromebooks - Delivery of school based services - PD for remotely providing these services would be helpful - PD committee working with Better Lessons - parking lot items- petition on line about students not wearing masks to school, but it could make some students/teachers vulnerable - we are working with DPH on these guidelines - SE is imperative - continue with roundtable sessions over summer - across district there are needs for social emotional supports

Group 4 - Member Van der Kloot - SOA - social emotional learning concerns, implicit bias training, responsive classrooms training, and important that everything we are doing is culturally relative, training should be culturally responsive and ongoing, not a flash in the pan - our full curriculum is not planned to be remote: Foreign language, science and math - those classes are very hands on - keep schools clean, so students can get back to school - one teacher had a concern about cheating, can't monitor - or younger children don't stay on the class as they wander off - kids love the specialties art, music and gym. Vocational difficulties and the need to get students out to coop opportunities as much as possible

Group 5 - Member Ruseau - SOA -literacy - Foss science is designed to be in person - vocational across the board need to be in person - desire for consistency - older students may need to help younger students due to parents working so we need to be careful of consistency - zoom recess and SE activities are important - might need to do things on zoom that might make no sense, but doesn't mean kids might not like them - concern about home schooling - if parents

opt for that, district could lose serious money if a number of families do it, our budget problems will be worse

Group 6 - Member Mustone - via Mr. Downs - SOA - PD for remote learning - continue subscriptions for online learning platforms that won't continue to be free - keep making arts program alive - for students who can't access online learning - all students need devices and hotspots- parking lot item - SE learning for students and staff - delivery of services - google voice

Group 7 - Member Graham - a lot of issues already discussed - SOA - focusing on executive function PD skills for students - intervention techniques where we have missed on instruction - Foss is built on in person group work - how is Foss suggesting we deliver it online? Math - difficult to type math - figuring out to facilitate math instruction at that level - specialists - Physical ed, art, etc, the experience was all over the board, some had great experiences some did not. Need for consistency for those specialist classes - Younger students K-2 struggle to learn online - how to provide the classroom experience via zoom - vocational education - finding a way to deliver materials to students - we need this option for those who can't access online learning - equity learning and one on one interactions were super effective - online extracurricular activities - district should be consistent -Delivery of services of OT, PT and then the food insecurity needs throughout the district.

Group 8 - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - SOA - Dr. Chiesa - mostly on technology and the need for hotspots - additional staffing for our most vulnerable students - topics that can't be delivered online - theme of K-2 hard, social interactions that are missed - Ms. Castignetti - shared a free app, called *Talking Point* - available in 33 different languages - have helped parents download it and it has helped teacher communication with all parents - delivery of school based services for students with high needs - they need the 1-1 with their teachers - parking lot items - what issues are we grappling with for in person classes - students don't want to wear masks for 6 hour days - will there be an option for distance learning for those who may not feel comfortable coming into school?

Group 9 - Ms. Abuhasan - (difficult to hear her)- busing is a huge concern - parents suggested they'd rather drive their children themselves, but what about the traffic issues that would cause? They have connectivity concerns and communicating concerns with teachers. Could packets and zoom be offered. Some students like to use pencil and paper and not just zoom

Group 10 - Ms. Pinto - many of the same concerns as other parents - live classes are best for younger students, children have interaction and help from the teacher, but also if those live

lessons could be taped so parents could log on and go over the information later with their children, that would be helpful.

Group 11 -Ms. Reinhold -parent is looking for PD in tech for parents and students - her oldest child has had to act as an assistant teacher due to the computer access necessary. She wished her internet access was better -she is anxious to get students back to school, but nervous about her younger child to wear a mask all day and not share items with other kids. Maybe only keep younger students in class for half a day?

Group 12 - Ms. Pierre- Paul - No one participated on this call, but some Haitian parents have reached out to me to say they don't know how to keep track of student work or how to check on their student's work - They requested some tech support or classes to assist their children with zoom classes.

Dr; Kay - If we had one platform for district - as it could be translated, that might be helpful for all parents. Elementary teachers need to see children's faces when teaching phonics so they would need masks off, and plexiglass in place - Therapies can't be done one on one online - materials need: such as colored paper for example or having a printer at home. How do we get families supplies and can paper and pencil be used so no printer is necessary? How do we get paper packets to students? Parking lot items - orientation for students and parents with specific guidelines - expectations posted grade level wise - on the MCM channel

Mayor - thank you all - we will probably have a lot more conversations to be had

Motion to adjourn by vMember Van der Kloot, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call - 7-0 - Motion passes

Meeting is adjourned - 5:45 PM